LONGEVITY 18

Thymalin

Mix of peptides (up to 10 kDa) extracted from calf thymus glands



CLASS
Peptide extract (calf thymus)

STUDIED FOR
Immune function, COVID-19, aging

HUMAN EVIDENCE
Small human studies

US STATUS
Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

COVID-19	Illness and death	T-cell maturation
HUMAN	HUMAN	ANIMAL

Mostly one research group. Nearly all studies come from one St. Petersburg group, many in Russian, and have not been repeated by independent researchers.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Thymalin → KE and EW peptides → Blood stem cells → T-cell markers

- **Calf-thymus extract,** a mix of peptides rather than one defined molecule
- **Dipeptides KE and EW** named as active parts by the developers
- **Raised CD28,** a mature T-cell marker, in human stem cells in the lab
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

SMALL HUMAN
LEVEL 3 OF 5

- Russian and Ukrainian studies only
- Open-label COVID-19 trial, 92 patients
- No trial on ClinicalTrials.gov

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Side-effect profile
- Which peptides are active

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
Not established in people

ROUTES STUDIED
Injection into muscle (COVID-19 trial)

PHARMACOKINETICS
Not established in people

SOLD AS
"Research use only" (not for human use) in the US

MONITORED IN TRIALS
Immune cells, IL-6, CRP, D-dimer, lung scans

SPORT (WADA)
Not named on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; not on compounding lists
WADA	Not named; S0 status depends on approval

REFERENCES

1. Stem Cell Rev Rep, thymalin in COVID-19, Feb 2021
2. Neuro Endocrinol Lett, thymalin and epithalamin in older people, Jun 2003
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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